

Work & Income Basics — Interview Practice Questions

(answer truthfully; only share what you truly know—don't guess).

1) Employer and job basics (each person)

- Where do you currently work (employer/company name)?
- What is your job title or role (simple description)?
- Where is the workplace located (city/town, general area)?
- How long have you worked there (approx month/year started)?
- Is it full-time, part-time, contract, or seasonal?

2) Work schedule and hours

- What are your typical work days (Mon–Fri, weekends, rotating)?
- What time do you usually start and finish work (approx)?
- Do your hours change week to week? If yes, how?
- Do you work overtime or double shifts sometimes? How often?
- If you work from home: which days and where do you work in the house?

3) Commute and transportation

- How do you get to work (drive, train, bus, rideshare, walk)?
- How long is the commute (approx minutes) and what route do you take (highway/local)?
- Who drives if you share a car?
- If public transit: which station/stop do you use (general area) and how often?
- Do you ever carpool? With who (general)?

4) Workplace routine and consistency checks

- Who usually leaves the house first on workdays and why?
- What time do you typically leave home for work?
- Do you eat lunch at work or bring lunch from home?
- Do you have a uniform or work badge? Where do you keep it at home?
- Do you have a consistent weekly schedule you could describe in 30 seconds?

5) Pay cycle and income basics (keep simple and truthful)

- How are you paid (hourly/salary)?
- How often are you paid (weekly, biweekly, twice monthly, monthly)?
- Do you receive direct deposit or paper checks?
- Which bank account does pay go into (joint vs separate)?
- Do you know your approximate take-home pay per pay period (only if you truly know)?

6) Household finances: how income supports bills

- Which bills does each person usually pay (rent, utilities, phone, internet, groceries)?
- How do you split expenses (50/50, proportional, one pays rent and the other groceries)?
- Do you transfer money to each other (Zelle/Venmo/cash) for shared expenses?
- Do you have autopay set up for any bills? Which ones and whose account is used?

7) Benefits through work (only what you know)

- Do you have benefits through work (health insurance, dental, 401(k), HSA/FSA)?
- If health insurance through work: who is on the plan (self, spouse, children)?
- Where do you keep benefit info/insurance cards (wallet, app, home folder)?

8) If one person is unemployed (if applicable)

- Is either person currently not working? Since when (approx)?
- Why are you not working right now (school, childcare, health, job search, layoff)?
- How are household bills covered during this time (spouse income, savings, family help)?
- Are you actively looking for work? What type of jobs and where (general)?
- Do you have any part-time, gig, or cash work (only describe truthfully)?

9) Past employment changes (timeline clarity)

- Have you changed jobs in the last 3–5 years? When and why?
- What was your previous employer and role (general)?
- Did a job change affect your move, finances, or schedule at home?

10) Proof and records (where things are kept)

- Where do you keep pay stubs or direct deposit records (email, portal, folder)?
- Do you file taxes together or separately (if applicable)?
- Where are tax documents stored (paper folder, cloud, email)?
- Do you have work schedules posted (app, calendar, text messages)?

11) “Reality check” questions (recent and specific)

- What time did you leave for work yesterday and who left first?
- When was the last payday and what was the pay period frequency?
- What was your last commute like (drive/train) and about how long?

- Which bill was paid most recently using work income and who paid it?

Tip: If you're unsure about exact dates, pay amounts, or plan names, check pay stubs/HR portal/bank deposits before answering. Don't guess.